

What NOT to Put in AI Tools

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1. Personally Identifiable Information (PII)

Avoid entering any PII into AI tools. This includes data that can be used to identify an individual.

- ☐ Full Name
- ☐ Email Address
- ☐ Phone Number
- ☐ Home Address
- ☐ Social Security Number (SSN)
- ☐ Date of Birth
- ☐ Driver's License Number
- ☐ Passport Number

Why: PII is protected by privacy laws like GDPR, CCPA, and HIPAA. Misuse can lead to severe penalties, including fines and legal action, along with reputational damage.

Safe Alternative: Use anonymized or pseudonymized data for testing and development. If PII is absolutely necessary, ensure the AI tool has robust security measures and complies with relevant privacy regulations. Consider data masking techniques.

2. Confidential Business Information

Protect your company's sensitive business data by not including it in AI tool inputs.

- ☐ Trade Secrets
- ☐ Financial Projections
- ☐ Customer Lists
- ☐ Pricing Strategies
- ☐ Product Development Plans
- ☐ Internal Memos
- ☐ Contracts
- ☐ Strategic Partnerships

Why: Disclosure of confidential business information can compromise your competitive advantage and potentially violate non-disclosure agreements (NDAs). This could result in financial losses and

legal repercussions.

Safe Alternative: Use synthetic data or aggregated, non-identifiable datasets to train and test AI models. Implement strict access controls and data encryption. Review AI tool provider's data security policies.

3. Financial Data

Keep financial data out of AI tools to avoid fraud and compliance issues.

- ☐ Credit Card Numbers
- ☐ Bank Account Numbers
- ☐ Transaction Histories
- ☐ Investment Portfolios
- ☐ Tax Identification Numbers (TIN)
- ☐ Loan Information
- ☐ Salary Details

Why: Financial data is highly sensitive and regulated by laws such as PCI DSS. Exposing this data can lead to identity theft, fraud, and significant regulatory fines.

Safe Alternative: Employ tokenization or encryption to protect financial data. Utilize AI tools that are specifically designed for secure financial data processing and comply with relevant regulations.

4. Health Information

Protect patient privacy by avoiding health-related data input into AI tools.

- ☐ Medical Records
- ☐ Diagnosis Information
- ☐ Treatment Plans
- ☐ Prescription Details
- ☐ Insurance Information
- ☐ Genetic Information
- ☐ Mental Health Records

Why: Health information is protected by HIPAA and other healthcare privacy laws. Unauthorized disclosure can result in substantial fines, legal penalties, and damage to patient trust.

Safe Alternative: Use de-identified or anonymized health data for AI development. Ensure that AI tools used in healthcare are HIPAA-compliant and have appropriate security measures in place. Obtain explicit patient consent when necessary.

5. Legal & Compliance Data

Avoid placing Legal and Compliance data in AI tools to stay safe legally.

- ☐ Legal Documents
- ☐ Compliance Reports
- ☐ Audit Logs
- ☐ Internal Investigations
- ☐ Regulatory Filings
- ☐ Litigation Strategies
- ☐ Attorney-Client Communications

Why: Exposure of legal and compliance data can waive legal privileges, compromise ongoing investigations, and lead to regulatory sanctions. It's crucial to maintain confidentiality.

Safe Alternative: Implement strict access controls and confidentiality agreements. Use AI tools that provide robust data security and comply with relevant legal and regulatory requirements. Consult with legal counsel before using AI for legal data processing.

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